

Innovation

G00438850 – Mobile Applications Development Project.

Navigation Updates

After building my application according to the spec, I tested it as a user and noticed two areas where I could improve navigation. The app allowed users to return to trending movies by clearing the search bar and pressing search(2 actions), or refreshing the page. I added a “Return to Home” button that appears when a search has been done. The button clears the search bar and calls `onSearch()`, which runs a search on an empty string. This calls `getTrending()` and displays trending movies on home page. I called `onSearch()` rather than `getTrending()` so I wouldn't have the same logic to get trending data in two different places.

I also added `(keyup.enter)` to the search input so pressing Enter does the same thing as clicking the search button. I understand that on a mobile app, the button would have to be pressed. But using the app with a keyboard, using Enter is what a user would expect from a search box.

Loading State and Ion-Spinner

API calls are asynchronous, there is a delay between the subscribe and the data arriving from TMDB. This delay, on a slow connection, could make it seem like the app is frozen. I added a loading state on the pages that make API calls, and used `IonSpinner` to display a spinner while waiting for the data to arrive.

I set `isLoading` to true on the line before subscribe, and flipped it to false inside subscribe when the data arrives. The template uses `*ngIf="isLoading"` on the ion-spinner when the API call is running, and `*ngIf="!isLoading"` on the ion-list so the list only renders when the data has arrived. Using two `*ngIfs` means that only one is ever in the DOM at a given time. The user will not see stale results from a previous search.